We may conclude that the PC has been able to unify not only the various economic policies of the centre but also those of the states with the help of these two new functions given to it. Earlier, there had always been a lack of congruence among the policies of the various central ministries and the ideas articulated by the PC.

## NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT COUNCIL

The National Development Council (NDC) was set up in August 1952, by a Resolution[59] issued from the cabinet secretariat. The first Plan recommended its formation with a very concise and suitable observation[60] about it:

"In a country of the size of India where the states have under the constitution full autonomy within their own sphere of duties, it is necessary to have a forum such as a National Development Council at which, from time to time, the Prime Minister of India and the Chief Ministers of the states can review the working of the plan and of its various aspects."

There were some strong reasons why the NDC was set up which may be seen as follows:

(i) The Central Plans were to be launched in the states and the UTs with the participation of the state level personnel. The as the Planning Commission was not provided with its own implementation staff (though the PC was given the responsibility of plan implementation) for this purpose. Therefore, the consent and co-operation of these federal units was a must.

(ii) Economic Planning as a concept had its origin in the centralised system (i.e. Soviet Union). For India, to democratise/decentralise the very process of planning was not a lesser task/challenge than promoting development itself. Indian planning is rightly said to be a process of trial and error in striking a balance between liberty and progress, central control and private initiative and national planning with local authority.[61]